June 25, 2026

Won Kim, MD, MPH
Editor-in-Chief
Clinical and Molecular Hepatology

Dear Dr. Kim,

We are pleased to submit our manuscript entitled "Clinical Outcomes Associated with Glucagon-Like Peptide-1 Receptor Agonist-Statin Combination vs Monotherapy in Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease: A Target Trial Emulation Study" for consideration for publication in *Clinical and Molecular Hepatology*.

In this large nationwide real-world study using the Merative™ MarketScan® database, we evaluated the clinical outcomes associated with combination therapy with GLP-1 RAs and statins among patients with metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease (MASLD). Using a target trial emulation framework with an active-comparator new-user design and time-conditional propensity score matching, we examined both hepatic and extrahepatic outcomes across different treatment sequences.

We found that combination therapy was associated with significant and clinically meaningful benefits compared with either monotherapy, with patterns of benefit differing according to background treatment context. Among GLP-1 RA initiators, the addition of statins was associated with reduced risks of cirrhosis, decompensated cirrhosis, and non-liver cancers. Conversely, among statin initiators, the addition of GLP-1 RAs was associated with reduced cardiovascular risk and decompensated cirrhosis. These findings suggest that combination therapy confers clinical benefits across both metabolic and cardiovascular risk domains, with its magnitude varying by treatment sequence and baseline risk, supporting its role as a targeted strategy to address residual risk in MASLD.

Given the increasing global burden of MASLD and its close links with metabolic and cardiovascular disease, we believe our findings are highly relevant to the readership of The Lancet Diabetes & Endocrinology, particularly in informing integrated, risk-based treatment strategies for patients with complex cardiometabolic conditions. This manuscript has not been published and is not under consideration elsewhere. All authors have approved the final version of the manuscript. The authors declare no conflicts of interest beyond those disclosed in the manuscript.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
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Combination therapy outcomes vary by treatment sequence and baseline risk profiles

Nationwide study (MarketScan database, >250 million individuals)

